DREAMS MADE ON CHARITY SHOP SHEETS

Maria Sappho · 2025
for many bodies and one 30-metre soft instrument
percussion sounds performed by Colin Frank



The audience plays the tube together from their seats. Photo: Brian Hartley, Still Motion Art

One instrument that needs many bodies to play it, like a gamelan. A very long, very soft rope crocheted from bed sheets found in charity shops, with a piezoelectric cable hidden inside that hears every shake, tug and rustle. Nobody can play it alone.

Premiered November 2025 at the CCA, Glasgow (GIOfest XVII), as part of *Tonna Miann*.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Lay the tube along the audience: across laps, along the rows, looped through the space.
2. It cannot be played alone. Invite everyone to pick up a piece of it.
3. Move together. Lift it, shake it, ripple it, pass a wave from one end to the other.
4. Listen through the tube. A single jolt rings out long. Many hands shaking scatter into short strikes.
5. When everyone becomes still, one last sound rings. Let it fade completely.
6. Begin again, or let go. The piece ends when the last person puts it down.

TWO WAYS TO PRESENT IT

Performance. Movement triggers Colin Frank's gongs, bells and tam-tams through the Teensy box. Calm brings long sounds, busy brings short ones.

Installation. Hang the tube in loops from the ceiling and simply amplify it through a guitar amp. No code, no samples. Drop in and play.

BUILD YOUR OWN

The crochet tube
cutting sheets, crocheting

The piezo cable
how it works, going wireless

Electronics
Teensy, Audio Shield, SD card

Installation version
hanging and amplifying

Code
upload and calibrate

The box
3D-print file

The sounds
pick 32 long + 32 short

Parts list
everything you need

Everything you need to build and perform the piece is in the repository.



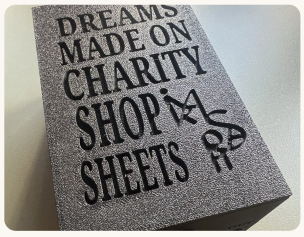
In performance



Cutting sheets into yarn



Sheet yarn



The box

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